



PROJECTORS

Desktop Projectors

Acer PD113

Specs: DLP, 800 x 600, 1600 Lumens, 2000:1 (Full On/Off), 4:3/16:9, 27.5" - 330" Projection Range, 200 Watts / 2000 Hours, 2 Kg

Our Verdict: The Acer PD113 sports a great set of features, prime amongst them being a healthy 1,600 lumen brightness and a zoom ratio of 1.2:1. It also has a high image display size of 330-inch diagonal, which is big enough to address an audience over 50.

The PD113 fared very well in our

movie tests, in both 4:3 and 16:9 aspect ratios.

Moreover, it sports the picture-in-picture mode, for when you need to showcase a movie presentation alongside graphs. The remote has features that afford flexibility and style. To top it all up, the Acer PD113 is priced just right.



Runner-Up: Sony VPL-ES2

Mobile Projectors

Panasonic PT-LM1E-C

Specs: LCD, 800 x 600, 1200 Lumens, 4:3/16:9, 33" - 300" Projection Range, 130 Watts / 4000 Hours, 1.6 Kg

Our Verdict: The Panasonic PT-LM1E-C—an LCD projector—returned good results in our presentation tests, with good colour reproduction and faithful animation. In our movie test, though, it only returned watchable results. Though it's not the

lightest projector in its class, carrying it around shouldn't be too much of an issue.

We present the PT-LM1E-C the Digit Zero1 Award for 2005 because it's a great all-round performer.



Runner-Up: BenQ PB2120

SURROUND SPEAKERS

2.1 Speakers

Bose Companion 3

Specs: Acoustimass Module (Subwoofer) and Two Satellite Speakers With a Control Pod, No Bass and Treble Controls, Volume Control With Feather-Touch Mute

Our Verdict: Bose calls its subwoofers 'Acoustimass'; whatever that means, the Companion 3 definitely comes with a wonderful subwoofer, so much so that we felt the satellites didn't match up. The two tiny speakers deliver amazing sound quality when playing anything, be it MP3s, CDs, DVDs or games. The speakers can also be

mounted on a monitor with speaker brackets.

The control pod houses a volume control and also provides a connection for a second audio source. If you are an audiophile, and if money is no object, you can't do any better than the Bose.



Runner-Up: JBL Creature II

Showstoppers!

Archos AV400

The 3.5-inch display may not make a spectacular impression on you, but the Archos AV400 is bundled with tons of features: video playback (including AVI and MPEG-4 in DivX format), audio playback (MP3, WMA, WAV), and image viewing (JPEG and BMP). Well, that sounds commonplace these days, but hang on: the Archos AV400 also has a CF card reader inbuilt, and it also supports a 4-in-1 adapter to read from different memory cards. And that's not all: you can use Windows Explorer to copy media files onto the device and when you unplug it, it automatically scans and classifies the files under Artist, Genre, Album, and Title! Updating a GB of

songs took all of three seconds—astounding!

The Bookmark feature allows you to resume a movie or song from where you left off. Virtual dub and front-end proprietary software ensures that encoding settings are auto-corrected, so it can play a non-optimised video file without framing (jerky playback).

The AV400 also allows you to record from a TV and play back movies or images to a TV. The feature list seems to go on and on: the thing can also be used as a Dictaphone! Creating, deleting and renaming of files, folders and playlists can be done within the player itself. This is one amazing, feature-packed player.

